
3.

Why psychology matters

Students will be assessed on their understanding of:

- a how eyewitness memory can be influenced by schemas drawing on two studies; and the importance of these influences for society and/or the individual.

Note: In the examination, students could be asked to demonstrate their understanding of stimulus material drawing on key terms and explanations.

Topic B Is dreaming meaningful?

1. Explaining the question: Is dreaming meaningful?

Students will be assessed on their understanding of:

- a Freud's (1900) dream theory including the concepts of manifest content, latent content and dreamwork (displacement, condensation and secondary elaboration), and their evaluation of the theory
- b the basic structure and function of a neuron: axon, impulse, neurotransmitter, synaptic transmission
- c Hobson and McCarley's (1977) activation-synthesis model including the concepts of random activation, sensory blockade and movement inhibition
- d explanations of dreaming offered by Freud, and Hobson and McCarley, by comparing and evaluating them.

In the examination, students could be asked to demonstrate their understanding of stimulus material drawing on key terms and explanations.

2. Investigating the question: Case studies

Students will be assessed on their understanding of:

- a the following terms, and their use when referring to methodology
 - i aim
 - ii case study
 - iii qualitative data
 - iv quantitative data
 - v privacy
 - vi confidentiality
 - vii generalisability
 - viii reliability
 - ix subjectivity and objectivity

Students could be asked to design a study from stimulus material, drawing on the terms above.

- b the ethical issues in case studies of humans of privacy and confidentiality and how they can be dealt with. (NB: The ethics of animal studies are discussed in Topic D.)
- c the case study as a research method including evaluation
- d the dream analysis of Little Hans in Freud (1909) *Analysis of a phobia of a five-year old boy* including evaluation of dream analysis as a research method.

3. Why psychology matters

Students will be assessed on their understanding of:

- a the role of the psychoanalyst including:
 - i who they might work for
 - ii what they do
 - iii skills required
 - iv qualifications required
 - v accreditation status
 - vi how they might use dream analysis to help someone.
- b how psychological sleep disorders (including REM sleep disorder) are treated at a sleep disorder clinic.

Note: In the examination, students could be asked to demonstrate their understanding of stimulus material drawing on key terms and explanations.

Unit 2 Social and Biological Psychological Debates

Content overview

Topic C: Do TV and video games affect young people's behaviour?

This topic covers the causes of aggression including biological and social learning causes.

Topic D: Why do we have phobias?

This topic considers social learning, conditioning and evolutionary causes of phobias.

Topic E: Are criminals born or made?

This topic considers proposed biological and social causes of criminality.

Assessment overview

- Assessed through an external examination.
- The paper consists of multiple choice questions, short answers and some extended writing and lasts 1 hour and 45 minutes.
- There are 90 marks in the examination and the result contributes 60% to the total grade for the full GCSE.

Methodological terms

Students will also be assessed on their understanding of the following terms from Unit 1, and their use when referring to methodology:

- i independent variable
- ii dependent variable
- iii experimental hypothesis
- iv experimental (participant) design: repeated measures and independent groups
- v control of variables
- vi qualitative data
- vii quantitative data
- viii generalisability
- ix reliability
- x subjectivity and objectivity
- xi ethical issues from Unit 1.